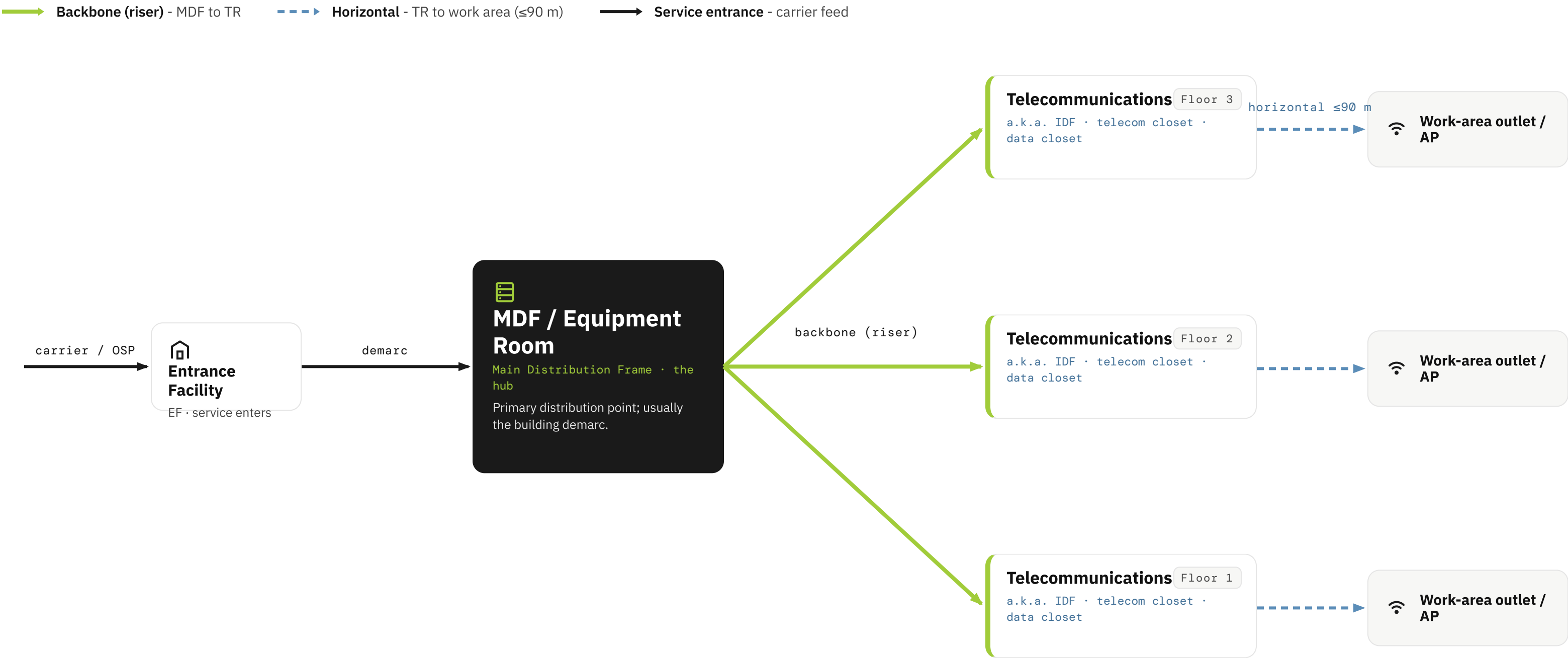


MDF, IDF, TR: the same rooms, decoded

TIA-569 lays out a hierarchical star - service enters at the Entrance Facility, the MDF is the hub, backbone risers reach a Telecommunications Room per floor, and horizontal cabling runs out to the AP.



READ THE ROOM Often the same room under four names. TIA-569's current vocabulary is **Equipment Room** and **Telecommunications Room (TR)**; the field still says **MDF** and **IDF** - both are legacy distribution-frame terms. "IDF," "TR," "telecom closet," and "data closet" usually describe the same space. The cabling math (the 100-meter rule) lives in the AEC plan-set reference; this card decodes the vocabulary.